

**preparation going?**

If I keep performing and doing well, I should be fine. I do have the Davis Cup and the Asian Games in mind. I will do everything in my power to get ready and represent India in both events.

**What are your thoughts on the Korean team, your opponents in the second round of the upcoming Davis Cup Qualifiers?**

They have very good players right now. (Soonwoo) Kwon is playing very well. I'm not sure who's going to play second singles. Maybe (Hyeon) Chung or (Seongchan) Hong, but I do know that they are a very tough team when they are together. Their energy is very high. They are from my age group. I have grown up with them since I was 12. I have known them for almost 15 or 16 years. They play with their heart when things are on the line.

**Tennis is a very tough sport, and you lose more often than you win. In these two years, was there any point when you felt a bit lost?**

Yes, there were weeks and even months. It's a little depressing sometimes. You go out, play for a year or two and not win a tournament. It's not a very nice feeling, but at the same time, there's also something called hope. Every week, you go in hoping that maybe this is the week things will turn because, in tennis, it just takes one week to change things. Sometimes it happens in three to six months, maybe a year or two, and sometimes it doesn't happen at all.

So, there were some bad days, I will not deny that, and there were

also days when I would go to a tournament and say, "Maybe this week changes my life."

**In the past, you've talked about facing financial issues. When you were in the Top 100, things would have been pretty solid, but since you dropped out, how have things been?**

If you make the main draw of a Slam, it really helps. Any tennis player would agree with that. In the last one and a half years, I haven't made the main draw of a Slam. The last one was the Australian Open in 2025.

People have been very kind and generous towards me, and that's been a great help over the last few months because I've barely played any tournaments or earned any decent amount of money. So, I would actually like to thank my sponsors, who have been there for me over when things were not going great.



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